

Shipment Exception Management SOP

AfaqRoute Logistics Services Co. (ARLS) | Saudi Arabia Operations

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Purpose

To establish one control-tower process for detecting, classifying, owning and resolving shipment exceptions before they cause avoidable service failures or contractual penalties.

Scope

Applies to road, air and sea shipments managed by ARLS in Saudi Arabia and GCC lanes, from booking confirmation through delivery or return-to-origin closure.

1. Detection and ownership

- Control Tower reviews active exceptions continuously during operating hours and at least every 30 minutes for priority accounts.
- Each exception must have one named owner until closure or a documented handover.
- Duplicate alerts caused by the same root issue are consolidated into one incident timeline.
- The first assessment must capture shipment status, last known location, promised delivery, remaining SLA hours, shipment value and current exception evidence.

2. Exception classes

Class	Examples	Initial response	Primary owner
Customs/document	Missing certificate, invoice mismatch, customs hold	30 min	Customs Coordinator
Carrier/transport	Missed linehaul, breakdown, capacity shortfall	30 min	Transport Operations
Customer/delivery	Consignee unavailable, refusal, access issue	15 min	Last Mile / CX
Supplier/origin	Late dispatch, cargo not ready	60 min	Origin Operations
External/closure	Holiday, terminal or border closure	60 min	Control Tower

3. Standard workflow

- Confirm the shipment reference, current physical status and latest reliable event.
- Identify the root cause using documents, carrier/broker updates and internal notes; clearly mark unconfirmed causes.
- Create a recovery action with owner, due time and expected outcome.
- Notify the customer if delivery commitment, cargo integrity, regulatory status or customer action is affected.
- Close only when the blocking condition is removed, an accepted alternative plan exists, or the shipment reaches final disposition.

4. Escalation thresholds

Condition	Escalation
Shipment value >= SAR 500,000	Duty Manager immediately; no unapproved rerouting
SLA breach forecast within 6 hours	Operations Manager and Account Owner
Customs hold > 24 hours	Customs Lead and Account Owner
Cross-border hold > 12 hours without confirmed reason	Regional Operations Manager
Second failed delivery attempt	Account Owner and Customer Service Lead
Potential penalty >= SAR 5,000	Commercial Manager

Records and audit trail

All material actions, timestamps, approvals, customer notifications and supporting evidence must be recorded against the shipment or incident reference in the transport management system.

Control note

This internal document does not replace Saudi laws, customs instructions, carrier terms, customer contracts or directions issued by competent authorities.